

The Golden Record

CHARACTER DESCRIPTIONS

Remus - 23, nepo baby, chronically online, degree in physics, but wanted to major in anthropology. He wants his dad to be proud/approve. He's okay at his job, but doesn't love it.

Victoria Vermicelli - 47, jeopardy superchamp, polyglot, she has six sons and is underappreciated (She's always being like "My kids think I'm so stupid! HAHAAHAAHHA!"). She's very unassuming, but sweet. She and her husband are separated. She wants to be appreciated, and she's falling in love with the guy in the group who only speaks Esperanto because she knows a little bit of Esperanto.

Willie - 12-year-old prodigy who was on Ellen, super emotionally mature, old soul, Remus' only friend at NASA, makes jokes about "What's become of this world." He quietly yearns for a normal childhood.

Mrs. LaDubious - 32, DJ, hyper pop singer, but really wants to write/sing folk music, eccentric, flowy dresses, always making sound bath sounds, always recording people's weird noises ("I need to get that."), writes beautiful music.

Olivia - 25, Mrs. LaDubious' sound engineer, mainly talks to LaDubious, reserved.

Georgo - 38, speaker of Esperanto, parents speak english, only taught him Esperanto

OUTLINE/TENTPOLE MOMENTS

ACT 1

https://canvas.uchicago.edu/courses/71498/pages/april-2-structure-and-workshopping-dramaturgy?module_item_id=3100980

1. Opening (*NASA Song*)

- 1.
2. Board room?
3. Message transmission room?
4. Willie is in the boardroom (dramatic irony)

2. Setup:

1. NASA is a place where BULLYING happens, but they're all smart. Remus is sort of an outcast. Everyone knows he just got the job because of his dad. Willie is his best friend. No one really talks to them, unless it's an insult. Remus is good at his job, but he doesn't really care about it.
2. 5 beats for setup

- i. **overture**
 - ii. **short scene**
 - iii. **musical number:**
 - 1. Opening number
 - iv. **establish main character outside of music:**
 - 1. Remus and his dad talking - set up that his dad is a very straight laced guy and remus is trying to get his approval
 - v. **Dad and Remus**
- 3. **Catalyst:** firm is officially landed the job
 - i. The NASA team gives Remus the task of creating a team and producing a new Golden Record.
 - ii. **I WANT SONG - Remus**
 - 1.

Debate:

- 2. Internal:
- 3. External:
- 4. B-plot: Willie yearns for a normal childhood
- 4. **5 beats for debate**
 - i. **Willie intro scene**
 - 1. Willie and Remus talk about the record
 - ii. **b plot character (willie) i am or charm song**
 - 1. Childlike wonder, longing for a childhood?
 - iii. **hero choosing a decision**
 - 1. Remus decides to take up the challenge and now has to find a group of people
 - iv. **Remus and Willie putting together a team; getting into action**
 - 1. Remus and willie decision song
 - 2. What kind of people would be on this team
- 5. **Threshold:**
 - The group meets for the first time at NASA.
 - (*Starstruck*)

ACT 2

3. ADAPTATION:

- 1. **Ladubious scene**
- 2. (*LaDubious song*)
- 3. **Lunch scene - they talk about making the record, we see v and g falling in love**
- 4. **Love song**
- 5. **Montage scene/song of them making the record**
- 6. **Scene with dad where the dad is like "i didnt have any faith in you but im proud of you au actually did it i know MY SON would never mushy gushy woke shit"**
 - i. Remus is about to show it to his dad, but then his dad says the above

- ii. This causes Remus to switch it out in the next song
- 7. The record is launched into space
 - i. Underneath, Remus is swapping it out (burn or shred the original)
- 8. Midpoint/**False Victory/Defeat: (1 year later = new status quo)**
 - i. False victory song - new status quo
 - ii. His dad is proud of him because they've created a record that is very appealing to the science community. The group is getting along well and has launched the record into space. Aliens have received the record. We can see that he's lying
- 9. **Things Fall Apart:**
 - 10. The aliens have decided to invade Earth because of what's on the record. An alien op tells Earth that this is going to happen. We learn that Remus changed the submitted record to match more of what his Dad would like and took away a lot of what the group loved about the record. The group is starting to fall apart, but now NASA needs them to make another record to convince the aliens not to invade (because Earth is actually worthy of life!)
 - 11. Aliens contact NASA say we're gonna invade cause you put this bs on here
 - 12. Scene where the group is like what the hell how could you do this
 - 13. GROUP/Willie initiated song to Remus being like how could you - Remus roast
 - i. Song: It only takes one? Name TBD-, rap, REMUS ROAST, 13, no longer a tween
 - a. Everyone else has a verse, can be in their own styles, ladubious could be a little melodic while others are more rap like, Esperanto guy speaks in Esperanto but like throws in a few English curse words that he's learned around NASA
- 14. **Nadir/False Defeat/Victory:**
 - i. Remus is all alone. The alien invasion is imminent - the time clock comes in. (Countdown Starts)
 - ii. 1 decision song about not going on
 - a. Remus destroys what the group made entirely (like the back up) — maybe he's worried his dad will find it so he shreds it.
- 15. **Doldrums:**
 - 1. 1 scene with B plot character giving good advice
 - a. Willie comes back. He's a man now (14) and he has advice to give
 - b. Willie also reveals that NASA doesn't really believe in them (cause of the board room at the beginning)
 - 2. possibly 1 "seduction" song compelling hero to finish the mission

ACT 3

Act 3: 10 more moments, hinge point around climax

- 16. **Epiphany:**
- 17. Epiphany - scene plus starstruck reprise

- i. To make the golden record—one that actually represents humanity—Remus has to embrace the things he loves and community. That’s what humanity really is and the only way to embody it. He doesn’t need his dad’s approval; he needs to do what he loves (anthropology over physics). There’s no true way to represent all of humanity. You just have to be what you love. Love your life—that’s what makes humanity worthy of life. *(Humanity, yay!)*
- ii. **epiphany, probably a song / decision point**

18. Gather Troops:

19. Scene: willie and remus have to figure out how to get everyone back together

- i. He needs to repair his relationships with all of these team members and get them to help him remake the record, so they can send it to the aliens and convince them that they are worthy of life. *They decide to start with Olivia because you can’t make a record without a producer? Willie approached Olivia because Olivia hates Remus rn. Willie sheepishly approaches Olivia who lets out her frustrations into a song about what is really special about a record.*

20. Olivia song

- i. They need her wisdom... idk
- ii. Something like “In the Groove” or “Find the Beats” or “**Something from Nothing**”

21. gathering the troops

- i. Getting them back from all the places they’ve gone off to; still behind his dad’s back (spy mission)

22. Scene:

- i. The audio engineer reveals that they’ve been recording all the songs that the group has sung before - this can be pretty comical Olivia is just like “wait guys this is soooo easy I already have everything recorded/I’ve been recording you this whole time (we thought it was non-diegetic, but the audio record is like “Bro, why don’t we just piece together all those songs you guys sang earlier”)

23. Scene or song 4: mashup of all the previous songs

- i. **This leads to a song that’s like a mashup of all the previous songs**

24. Climax: 1 beat

25. Scene

- i. Now that the group is back together and they have the new record to send up to the aliens. There’s an upcoming rocket launch to communicate with the aliens (they’re sending Brad from HR to convince them not to invade).

26. song

- i. Mrs. LaDubious is the key player in distracting Brad off the rocket. The group puts the record on the rocket. (*LaDubious Reprise*)
- 27. [I think we should add a scene + song here to wrap up the dad storyline; I think he should face his dad and still go through with the mission]
- 28. **Scene**
 - i. The aliens get the record and decide not to invade because humanity deserves to live (and also the music was so heat that the aliens want to spare humanity, so they can keep getting new music).
- 29. **Denouement: 2 moments of denouement**
- 30. **Final scene**
 - i. **endpoint of arc for main character or firmly wrap up b plot**
 - ii. NASA is proud of them for saving the day. The group is now separated, each of them at the top of their own game, but once a year, they get back together to make music for the aliens.
- 31. **Ending: finale moment**
 - i. **FINAL SONG**
 - ii. The group, now a band, performs a song for NASA. (*Closing Song*)

MUSIC

Song Outline:

ACT 1:

- 1. ~~NASA Opening~~ — Remus, Dad, Willie, Ensemble
- 2. ~~“We All Have A Part To Play”~~ — Dad and Remus
- 3. ~~“Textbook Scientist”~~ — Remus
- 4. ~~“Willie’s Song”~~ — Willie
- 5. ~~“Give Them A Call”~~ — Willie and Remus
- 6. ~~“Starstruck”~~ — Remus
- 7. ~~“I’m Me”~~ — LaDubious
- 8. ~~“Danci Kun Mi”~~ — Victoria and George
- 9. ~~“On the Record”~~ — Remus, Willie, LaDubious, Victoria, George, Olivia
- 10. ~~“Liftoff”~~ — Ensemble, Dad, Remus

ACT 2:

- 11. ~~New Status Quo~~ — Ensemble, Remus, Dad, Willie
- 12. **ALIEN SONG** - Ensemble
- 13. **Remus Roast** - Willie, Victoria, LaDubious, Olivia, George

14. ~~"45 Days"~~ - Ensemble and Remus
15. ~~"Starstruck - Reprise"~~ - Willie and Remus
16. ~~"Amplify"~~ - Olivia
17. ~~New Record~~ - Remus, Willie, Victoria, LaDubious, Olivia, Georgo
18. ~~"You"~~ - LaDubious
19. ~~Dad and Remus fight song~~ - Remus
20. Closing Song - Remus, Willie, Victoria, LaDubious, Olivia, Georgo
 - a. Remus: Bass
 - b. Willie: Drums
 - c. LaDub: Acoustic Guitar
 - d. Georgo: Percussion
 - e. Victoria: Guitar
 - f. Olivia: Keys